electronic telephone exchange; road carpeting; bridge repairs; wireless equipment; and many other facilities. Three defence helicopters were pressed into service for road clearance. Cranes were brought in from Delhi. A signals system was incorporated to assist traffic policemen, constant air surveillance was provided and, best of all, over 1200 students of Goa colleges joined in for traffic duties.

All these 'bonanzas' were made possible by the then lieutenant governor of Goa, Daman and Diu, K. T. Satarawala, and Kiran Bedi's strong belief in community cooperation. Regular meetings were held with businessmen and heads of institutions to discuss and plan out traffic management methods, and the community responded in a very generous way. Goa came on the world map with all its bounties of nature.

The Commonwealth heads of government were housed at a top-notch hotel, called Fort Aguada (of the Taj Group), located on the Aguada beach, one of the most beautiful beaches of Goa. The meeting of these heads was also scheduled to take place in the same hotel. Special cottages had been constructed for the visiting dignitaries. Prime Ministers Indira Gandhi and Margaret Thatcher (from the UK) were the star attractions, besides Queen Elizabeth herself. Amongst the men, the most sought after was Prime Minister Pierre Trudeau of Canada. The route from the airport to Fort Aguada was 40-km long and the VIPs had a choice between going overland or flying by helicopter. Some chose to travel by road. This meant giving them a total right of way all along the 40-km route. The route was one long stretch, with only intertwining small lanes. Since the motorcades would be expected to be driving past very fast, it had to be ensured that no vehicle or pedestrian came in the way. Therefore, it was all the more essential for all these small lanes to be physically manned by vigilant cops at the point where they met the main VIP carriageway. Where was the manpower to come from? The twenty-five Goa policemen were far too inadequate to meet the traffic requirements for the airport route, for all the places where the functions would be held and for normal traffic outside as well as within the four towns of Panaji, Margao, Mapusa and Vasco da Gama. Kiran drafted a few policemen from the neighbouring state of Karnataka, who had reported for duty. But they were not trafffic trained.

CHOGM was one great occasion for the Goans to participate in. But alas! It was to be an all-VIP affair that had no place for the common man. The people of Goa would only hear the helicopters flying over their heads and the zooming of the speeding cars on their roads! Security regulations required them to be kept away. But not necessarily from traffic arrangements. Kiran required many hands for making route arrangements, and discovered this was a great occasion for legitimately involving the young Goans and at least letting them become witnesses to some of the goings-on so that this young generation could carry forward the memory of the event. She decided to involve all the NCC cadets of Goa in traffic regulation, all along the VIP route.

Goa's youth participated enthusiastically in CHOGM, and not merely as spectators, but also as trained police cadets. All the 1200 youngsters recruited for the job turned out in white and blue dresses, red lanyards, whistles, white socks and PT shoes. All of them sported golf caps. Girls had tied their hair, while the boys had theirs neatly trimmed. These youngsters had been trained over a period of six Sundays in traffic drills by Kiran Bedi and her team of officers; her Delhi Police junior colleague, Subinspector Sarabpal Singh, who was a great asset for her during the Delhi Asian games, had been specially called for this purpose. The cadets had learnt to regulate traffic and salute smartly! It was these youngsters who managed the bylanes, which otherwise would have been unattended. While doing their duty, they also waved at the dignitaries driving past, who saw strings of students dotted all along the 40-km route. It was a rare sight to see! The students attracted the attention of one and all. President Trudeau and Mrs Gandhi stopped their motorcades to say 'hello' to some of them.